Milestone 2: Project Report
How JPMorgan Chase Built and Grew Its Branch Network?

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Business background

For this individual project, I chose the Chase Bank Branch Deposits, 2010-2016 dataset from Kaggle. This dataset includes a record for every branch of Chase Bank in the United States, including the branch's name and number, date established as a bank office and (if applicable) acquired by JP Morgan Chase, physical location as street address, city, state, zip, and latitude and longitude coordinates, and the amount deposited at the branch (or the institution, for the bank's main office) between July 1 and June 30, 2016, in US dollars.

Therefore, my main story focus was to find out how JPMorgan Chase built and grew its branch network. Focusing on its growth patterns and trajectory, I want to reveal how the bank navigated its expansion in the US market and became a dominant force in the financial sector.

Problems Identified

My target audience is Financial Analysts at JPMorgan Chase who want to conduct an analysis of how the bank built and grew its branch network in the US. Hence, they want to know the bank's branch network history and trends, which will help them advice their company executives on future growth opportunities. The critical questions answered by the visualizations are:

- Where are the branches and how big are they?
- Does branch origin explain deposit size?
- Which states are high-value vs. high-growth?
- Which specific cities drive total deposits?
- How do branch count and deposit wealth compare by state?
- Where should the bank invest next?

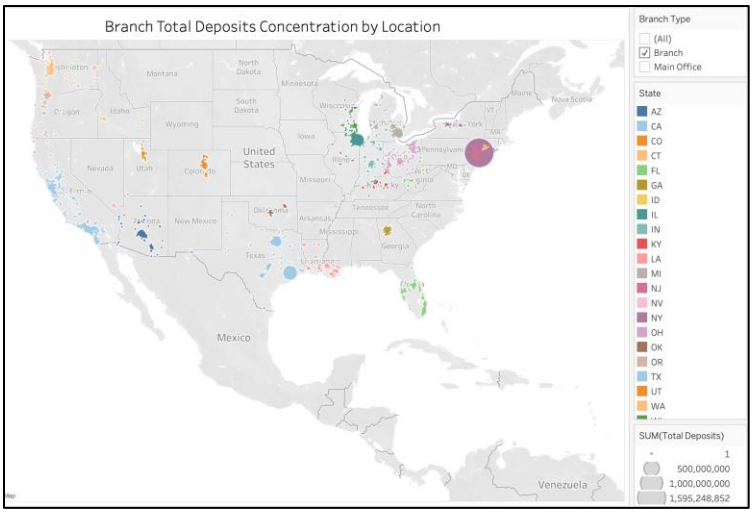
Analysis

Based on the problems identified, my main project objective is to build simple and unique visualizations that answer the critical questions above. Each of these visualizations will help the Financial Analysts get a better understanding of how the bank grew over the years, the growth patterns in different states, cities, and branches. It will tell a strategic story of systematic growth and success which further encourages the bank's presence in the US market.

Data Analysis

Visualization 1: Symbol Map

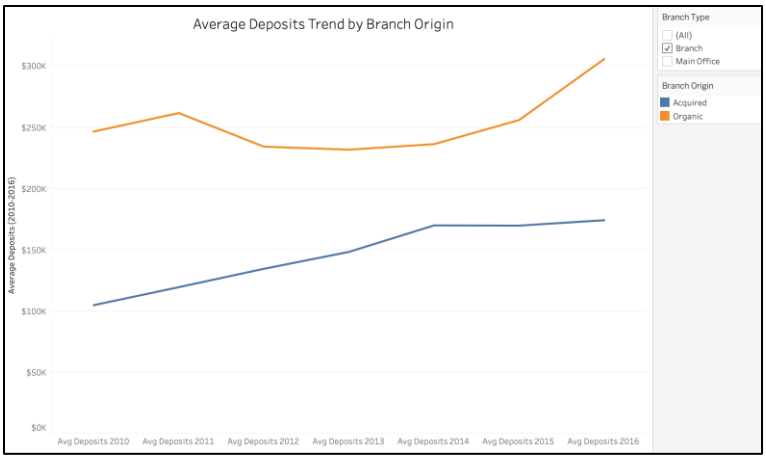
Focus: Branch Total Deposits Concentration by Location.



JPMorgan Chase's retail branch network spans 26 states with thousands of branches distributed across the United States. Deposit concentration is visibly highest in the Midwest and Northeast, particularly around major metropolitan areas such as New York City, Chicago, and Houston. This geographic pattern is consistent with JPMorgan Chase's growth strategy, which historically prioritized expansion in densely populated urban markets where higher household incomes, greater commercial activity, and stronger business banking demand naturally drive larger deposit volumes per branch. The relative scarcity of branches in the western states, combined with smaller bubble sizes in those regions, suggests that JPMorgan Chase's penetration in markets such as the Pacific Northwest and Mountain West remains limited compared to its established strongholds in the East and Midwest.

Visualization 2: Line Chart

Focus: Average Deposits Trend by Branch Origin.

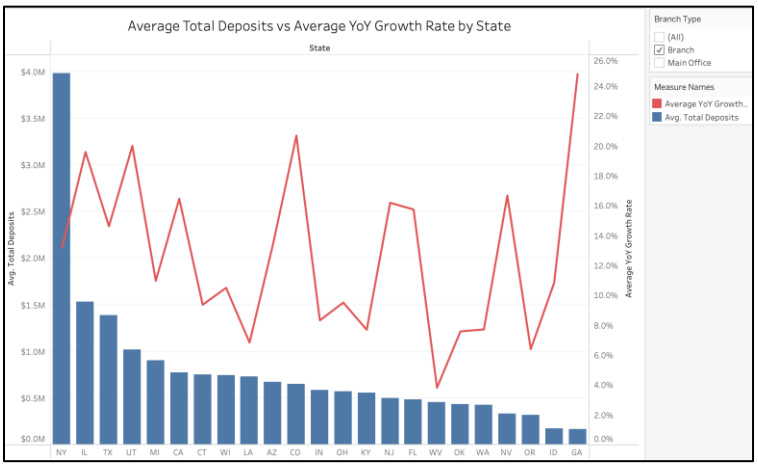


Organic branches consistently hold significantly higher average deposits than acquired branches across all years from 2010 to 2016, with the gap widening sharply after 2013. Organic branches begin the period at $247K in average deposits and accelerate to $306K by 2016, while acquired

branches grow more slowly from $105K to $174K over the same period. The most probable explanation for this persistent gap is that organic branches were deliberately opened in high-value, strategically selected locations such as dense urban or affluent suburban markets where deposit potential was identified in advance. Acquired branches, by contrast, were inherited through mergers and acquisitions and reflect the deposit base of the acquired institution, which may have served lower-income or less commercially active markets. The widening gap after 2013 likely reflects JPMorgan Chase's increasing investment in its organic branch network following the post-financial-crisis stabilization period, during which the bank focused on optimizing existing locations rather than pursuing aggressive acquisition-driven expansion.

Visualization 3: Dual-Axis Bar

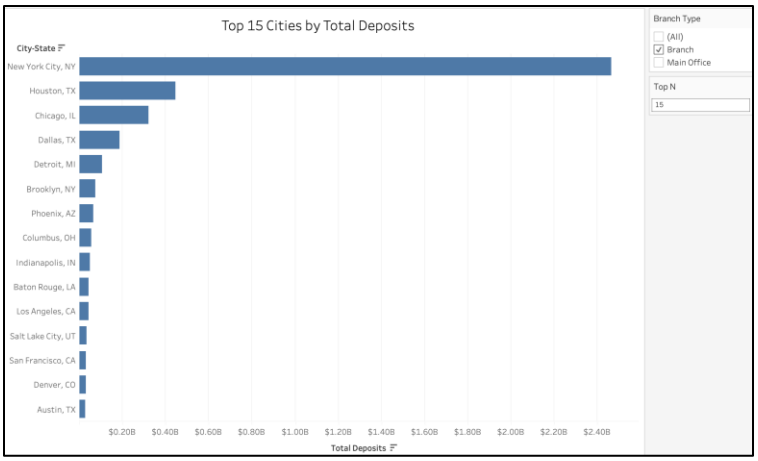
Focus: Average Total Deposits vs Average YoY Growth Rate by State.



The dual-axis chart reveals a clear inverse relationship between average total deposits per branch and average year-over-year growth rate across JPMorgan Chase's 26-state network. New York leads all states in average total deposits at $4.0M per branch but shows a comparatively modest YoY growth rate, while Georgia, the lowest deposit state, records the highest YoY growth rate of 24.8%. This pattern most likely reflects market maturity: states like New York, Illinois, and Texas have deeply established branch networks in saturated urban markets where deposit growth is constrained by competition and market saturation, leaving limited room for rapid percentage-based increases. Conversely, states like Georgia, Colorado, and Florida represent relatively newer or less penetrated markets for JPMorgan Chase, where a smaller existing deposit base means that even modest absolute deposit gains translate into high percentage growth rates. The inverse relationship confirms that high deposit value and high growth are structurally difficult to achieve simultaneously within the same market.

Visualization 4: Horizontal Bar

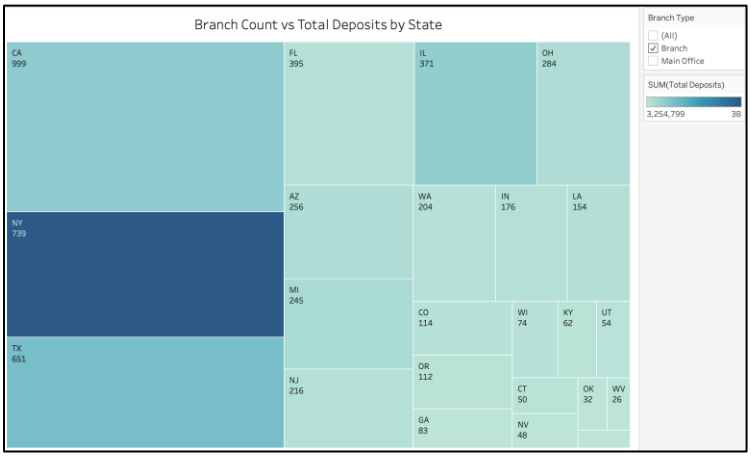
Focus: Top 15 Cities by Total Deposits.



Among JPMorgan Chase's top 15 retail branch cities by total deposits, New York City stands significantly above all others, holding more total deposits than the next several cities combined. Houston ranks second, followed by Chicago, Dallas, and Detroit. The dominance of New York City is attributable to several compounding factors: the city hosts the largest concentration of JPMorgan Chase branches of any single urban market, serves as a major financial hub with high commercial and institutional deposit activity, and benefits from the highest average household wealth and business density in the country. The presence of Texas cities like Houston and Dallas in the top five reflects JPMorgan Chase's strong and long-established retail presence in Texas, which is one of its largest state networks by branch count. The appearance of cities such as Brooklyn and Phoenix further down the list indicates that deposit wealth is increasingly distributed across secondary urban markets, though at volumes significantly below the top tier.

Visualization 5: Tree Map

Focus: Branch Count vs Total Deposits by State.

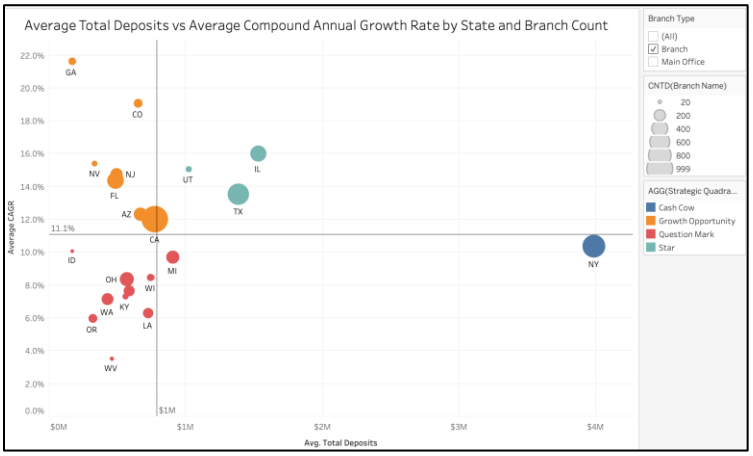


The tree map reveals a fundamental disconnect between branch count and deposit wealth across JPMorgan Chase's state network. California leads all states in branch count with 999 branches, yet its box is relatively light in color, indicating moderate total deposits relative to its network

size. New York operates 739 branches, significantly fewer than California, but holds the darkest color in the tree map, confirming it as the clear deposit wealth leader. This efficiency gap is most likely explained by the stark difference in average deposit value per branch between the two states: New York's branches are concentrated in high-density, high-income urban markets such as Manhattan, Brooklyn, and the greater New York metro area, where individual branch deposits are substantially larger. California's branches, while numerous, are more geographically dispersed across a diverse range of markets such as lower-income suburban and semi-urban areas, which dilutes the average deposit per branch. This contrast highlights that network scale alone is not a reliable indicator of deposit performance, and that market quality and branch placement matter significantly more than raw branch count.

Visualization 6: Scatter Plot

Focus: Average Total Deposits vs Average Compound Annual Growth Rate (CAGR) by State and Branch Count.



The strategic quadrant scatter plot tells us the full story of JPMorgan Chase's branch network, with each state positioned by its average total deposits per branch on the x-axis and its average compound annual growth rate from 2010 to 2016 on the y-axis, sized by branch count. Illinois, Texas, and Utah emerge as Stars because they have above-average deposit wealth with above-average CAGR, most likely because these states benefit from a combination of established high-value urban markets and sustained economic growth that continues to attract new deposits. Georgia, Colorado, Florida, Nevada, New Jersey, and Arizona are classified as Growth Opportunities, exhibiting high CAGR despite relatively low average deposits, suggesting these are untapped markets where JPMorgan Chase's branch network has not yet reached its full deposit potential, making them the strongest candidates for increased investment and branch expansion. New York sits alone as a Cash Cow, with by far the highest average deposits but below-average CAGR, reflecting a mature and saturated market where the bank already commands a dominant position but has limited room for further percentage-based growth. Question Mark states such as West Virginia, Oregon, Kentucky, and Louisiana show both low

deposits and low growth, indicating markets where JPMorgan Chase's presence is limited, local economic conditions are weaker, or the competitive landscape makes meaningful deposit growth structurally difficult, suggesting these states warrant reduced strategic priority in the near term.

Conclusion

To conclude, the analysis of JPMorgan Chase's retail branch network across 26 states from 2010 to 2016 demonstrates that deposit performance is driven not by the size of a branch network, but by the strategic quality of its composition. By examining deposit concentration geographically, distinguishing organic from acquired branch performance, identifying the tension between high-value and high-growth markets, and synthesizing state-level positioning into a strategic quadrant framework, this analysis resolves a critical strategic ambiguity which is that the bank's most deposit-rich markets are not its fastest growing ones, and its fastest growing markets remain significantly underleveraged in deposit terms. This finding directly addresses the core problem of resource allocation: without this analysis, investment decisions risk being guided by scale alone, overprioritizing large but saturated markets like New York while overlooking high-growth opportunities in states like Georgia, Colorado, and Florida where the bank's deposit footprint has not yet reached its potential.

The value delivered to the audience is a clear, data-grounded framework for prioritizing where JPMorgan Chase should direct its next wave of branch investment, shifting focus from defending mature Cash Cow markets toward aggressively expanding in Growth Opportunity states that combine strong CAGR with significant untapped deposit capacity, thereby maximizing the long-term return on the bank's branch network.